Toronto Rent Decisions: Data sources

Hack the Valley 11 · for the Toronto municipal election, Monday, October 26, 2026 · compiled 2026-10-17

Listings, landlords, offers and personas in the game are fictional and labelled "illustrative". Every real number and teaching point comes from the sources below. Each figure on screen carries a provenance chip (measured, derived, illustrative or unknown) that links back to its source.

1. Toronto housing data

Source	Used for	Checked
CMHC Rental Market Survey, Toronto, October 2025 (data tables, xlsx) https://assets.cmhc-schl.gc.ca/sites/cmhc/professional/housing-markets-data-and-research/housing-data-tables/rental-market/rental-market-report-data-tables/2025/rmr-toronto-2025-en.xlsx?rev=f107330e-4620-4462-9027-8c6ff1522f1a	Table 1.1.9: average rent of vacant vs. occupied private apartments by survey zone (listing benchmark; $2,020 vs $1,754 city 1-bed). Table 1.1.1: 1-bed vacancy rate (3.5% Oct 2025, 2.7% Oct 2024). Table 1.1.2: average 1-bed rent ($1,763 vs $1,715).	2026-10-16
CMHC Housing Market Information Portal: survey-zone polygons (2026 geography) https://geospatial.cmhc-schl.gc.ca/server/rest/services/CMHC_APPS/HMIP_CURRENT_CAWD/FeatureServer/2	Assigns each game neighbourhood to a CMHC survey zone by largest area overlap (provisional: 2026 polygons vs. 2021-based zones).	2026-10-16
City of Toronto Neighbourhood Profiles, 2021 Census (158-model, xlsx) https://ckan0.cf.opendata.inter.prod-toronto.ca/dataset/6e19a90f-971c-46b3-852c-0c48c436d1fc/resource/19d4a806-7385-4889-acf2-256f1e079060/download/nbhd_2021_census_profile_full_158model.xlsx	Row 378: % of tenant households spending 30%+ of income on shelter. Row 380: median rented shelter cost. Row 376: tenant households (used to derive the city-wide 40.0%).	2026-10-17
City of Toronto Neighbourhoods (158), boundaries https://ckan0.cf.opendata.inter.prod-toronto.ca/dataset/fc443770-ef0a-4025-9c2c-2cb558bfab00/resource/0719053b-28b7-48ea-b863-068823a93aaa/download/neighbourhoods-4326.geojson	Neighbourhood IDs, names and boundaries.	2026-10-16
City of Toronto Open Data: Apartment Building Evaluations (RentSafeTO) https://open.toronto.ca/dataset/apartment-building-evaluation/	Latest evaluation per building: 3,593 buildings, 327,879 units, 270 scoring under 80/100 (stat cards).	2026-10-17

2. Official figures, fares and rules

Source	Used for	Checked
Canadian Anti-Fraud Centre: Fraud Prevention Month 2025 (page modified 2025-03-24) https://antifraudcentre-centreantifraude.ca/features-vedette/2025/02/month-prevention-mois-eng.htm	In 2024: 108,878 fraud reports and over $638 million in reported losses (Canada, all fraud types).	2026-10-17
Tribunals Ontario 2024–2025 Annual Report https://tribunalsontario.ca/documents/TO/Tribunals_Ontario_2024-2025_Annual_Report.html	The Landlord and Tenant Board received 87,993 applications in fiscal 2024–25.	2026-10-17

Source	Used for	Checked
Government of Ontario: Residential rent increases https://www.ontario.ca/page/residential-rent-increases	2026 rent increase guideline of 2.1%; units first occupied after Nov 15, 2018 are exempt from rent control.	2026-10-17
TTC: Back to school on the TTC (September 4, 2026) https://www.ttc.ca/news/2026/September/Back-to-school-on-the-TTC	$3.30 adult PRESTO/debit/credit; $128.15 post-secondary monthly pass with TTC Post-Secondary Student Photo ID; 47-paid-trip monthly cap with the same payment method.	2026-10-17
TTC: Monthly fare capping https://www.ttc.ca/riding-the-ttc/Updates/Monthly-fare-capping-coming-to-the-TTC	Fare-capping page reachable (HTTP 200).	2026-10-17
TTC: Fares and passes https://www.ttc.ca/Fares-and-passes	Two-hour transfer; 47-fare cap; capping began August 31, 2026.	2026-10-16

3. Civic levers and election information

Source	Used for	Checked
City of Toronto: Agencies (TTC listed as a Service Agency) https://www.toronto.ca/city-government/accountability-operations-customer-service/city-administration/city-managers-office/agencies-corporations/agencies/	TTC service standards: TTC manages and operates the City's subways, streetcars, buses and Wheel-Trans; service agencies are governed by a Board with delegated decision-making authority from City Council (page modified 2025-12-04).	2026-10-17
TTC report: Overview of TTC Service Standards (Strategic Planning Committee, September 4, 2025) https://www.toronto.ca/legdocs/mmis/2025/tts/bgrd/backgroundfile-258031.pdf	TTC service standards: Board-approved service standards are applied at every level of TTC service planning; example standards for peak frequency, vehicle crowding and on-time departures; review to report back in Q4 2026.	2026-10-17
City of Toronto: RentSafeTO for tenants: service requests https://www.toronto.ca/community-people/housing-shelter/rental-housing-rights-information/housing-property-standards/apartment-building-standards/rentsafeto-for-tenants/rentsafeto-for-tenants-service-requests-complaints-investigations/	RentSafeTO and the indoor temperature bylaw: Requests in writing, keep a copy; 24-hour urgent and seven-day non-urgent response; 311 if unresolved (page modified 2026-02-24).	2026-10-17
City of Toronto: Indoor temperatures in apartment units https://www.toronto.ca/community-people/housing-shelter/rental-housing-rights-information/housing-property-standards/indoor-temperatures-in-apartment-units/	RentSafeTO and the indoor temperature bylaw: 21°C minimum October 1 to May 15 where the owner pays for heat; 311 if unresolved (page modified 2026-09-01).	2026-10-17
Government of Ontario: Residential rent increases https://www.ontario.ca/page/residential-rent-increases	Ontario rent increase guideline: 2026 guideline 2.1%; maximum most tenants' rent can rise without Landlord and Tenant Board approval; post-November 15, 2018 units exempt (page updated 2026-06-23).	2026-10-17
City of Toronto Elections (municipal election Monday, October 26, 2026) https://www.toronto.ca/city-government/elections/	Election date and official City election information.	2026-10-17

Source	Used for	Checked
Government of Ontario: Renting in Ontario, your rights https://www.ontario.ca/page/renting-ontario-your-rights	Linked when the landlord in the negotiation is asked a legal question (never paraphrased).	2026-10-17

4. Teaching points (data/game/content.json)

28 teaching points, each a short claim from an official page, with the date it was checked.

Source	Used for	Checked
Competition Bureau Canada: Rental scam: no room for error https://www.canada.ca/en/competition-bureau/news/2018/08/rental-scam-no-room-for-error.html	Teaching points: scam-below-market, scam-no-viewing, scam-deposit-first, scam-personal-info, scam-report	2026-10-17
CMHC: Visiting the rental property https://www.cmhc-schl.gc.ca/consumers/renting-a-home/i-want-to-rent/visiting-the-rental-property	Teaching points: view-water-damage, view-locks, view-ask-included	2026-10-17
City of Toronto: Smoke alarms https://www.toronto.ca/community-people/public-safety-alerts/safety-tips-prevention/safety-equipment-devices/smoke-alarms/	Teaching points: view-smoke, live-smoke	2026-10-17
City of Toronto: RentSafeTO for tenants: service requests https://www.toronto.ca/community-people/housing-shelter/rental-housing-rights-information/housing-property-standards/apartment-building-standards/rentsafeto-for-tenants/rentsafeto-for-tenants-service-requests-complaints-investigations/	Teaching points: view-pests, live-written-requests	2026-10-17
Ontario Human Rights Commission: Human rights for tenants https://www.ohrc.on.ca/en/human-rights-tenants-brochure	Teaching points: apply-can-ask, apply-no-credit	2026-10-17
Landlord and Tenant Board: A Guide to the Residential Tenancies Act https://tribunalsontario.ca/documents/ltb/Brochures/Guide%20to%20RTA%20(English).html	Teaching points: apply-deposit-limit, lease-entry, live-repairs-ltb, moveout-deposit	2026-10-17
Government of Ontario: Guide to Ontario's standard lease https://www.ontario.ca/page/guide-ontarios-standard-lease	Teaching points: lease-standard, lease-void-pets-guests, lease-void-fees, lease-void-repairs, lease-insurance	2026-10-17
CMHC: Inspections https://www.cmhc-schl.gc.ca/consumers/renting-a-home/i-am-renting/inspections	Teaching points: movein-document	2026-10-17
City of Toronto: Indoor temperatures in apartment units https://www.toronto.ca/community-people/housing-shelter/rental-housing-rights-information/housing-property-standards/indoor-temperatures-in-apartment-units/	Teaching points: live-heat	2026-10-17
Government of Ontario: Residential rent increases https://www.ontario.ca/page/residential-rent-increases	Teaching points: live-rent-increase	2026-10-17

Source	Used for	Checked
TTC report: Overview of TTC Service Standards (September 4, 2025) https://www.toronto.ca/legdocs/mmis/2025/tts/bgrd/backgroundfile-258031.pdf	Teaching points: live-ttc	2026-10-17
Landlord and Tenant Board: How a Tenant Can End Their Tenancy https://tribunalsontario.ca/documents/ltb/Brochures/How%20a%20Tenant%20Can%20End%20Their%20Tenancy.html	Teaching points: moveout-notice	2026-10-17

Generated from the game's own data files (evidence.json, stats.json, levers.json, content.json). Derived values: the city-wide share of tenants spending 30%+ on shelter is a tenant-weighted average of the 158 neighbourhood figures; RentSafeTO counts use each building's latest evaluation. CMHC data: adapted, not endorsed by CMHC. City of Toronto data: Open Government Licence – Toronto. Nonpartisan: no candidate endorsements, voting advice or legal advice.